

of Chromebooks that support Android apps, bolstering the web store and its offerings can only work in Chrome's favour.

Due to the ubiquity of the Chrome browser on our phones and other devices, and with a Google account connecting all of it, one of the biggest things working in Google's favour is the uniform user experience. And that is where Google also faces the most flak – privacy. While measures have been implemented to reassure users, it remains to be seen how Google fares in the modern day browser wars. Especially with newer platforms like augmented reality and virtual reality calling for entirely new web browsing experiences (<http://dgit.in/ARChrome>). Be sure to check out our browser comparison in the main mag.

Gmail and Inbox

While the actual market share is less as compared to Chrome, Google's email service Gmail also holds the biggest share of the email market. At 21% as of July 2017, both businesses as well as consumers have increasingly chosen Gmail over other services over the past few years. One of the key factors behind that is how easy it is to set up a Gmail account (which, as it turns out, is a Google account) today. But it wasn't this easy to begin with - Gmail started off as invite only.



There was a reason behind that. Gmail, at its beginning, offered one gigabyte of storage to every user – way more than what competitors were offering. But when it launched, the infrastructure was in no way close to support an open release. Hence it was released to a limited group of 1000 'opinion leaders' in 2004 and allowed them to send invites. This

decision, implemented due to technical limitations, ended up becoming one of the best marketing decisions Google has ever made. The exclusivity drove popularity until aftermarket prices of Gmail invites went as high as \$150. Eventually, Google made invites easily available and the aftermarket collapsed.

With Gmail, Google promised to give more and more space to users forever. In fact, a progressing ticker on Gmail's login page indicated the same for a pretty long time. Within a year from its launch storage had doubled to 2GB and eventually, down the road, Google integrated the storage for